

RECAP SCRIPT

As Good As Dead (2022)

Movie Abyss · Ready to narrate at about 200 words a minute

WORDS

3,101

EST. RUNTIME

15:30

CHAPTERS

12

Chapters for the description

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Chapter headings are for the editor and the description only. Do not read them aloud.

0:00 Chapter 1: The man who trains alone

The story begins in Nogales, Mexico, with a quiet, mysterious man named Bryant. Bryant lives alone and keeps to himself. Nobody in town really knows who he is or where he came from. But every single morning, he follows the exact same routine. He trains alone, practicing martial arts with incredible discipline and precision. And there is one person who never misses this show. A teenage boy named Oscar.

Oscar watches Bryant train from a distance almost every day. He is so hooked on Bryant's movements that he completely loses track of time. That's one of the reasons Oscar is late to school again and again. Remember this habit, because this one boy watching from a distance is what eventually pulls Bryant's whole hidden past back into the open.

Oscar's life is already complicated. His older brother Hector is in prison, which leaves Oscar without anyone to guide him. And the people around him are not good influences either. Hector was part of a gang. And while Hector is locked up, his fellow gang members are the ones looking out for Oscar. They even give him money for gas. But in this world, nothing is free. That money is a loan, and the gang expects every bit of it back.

1:03 Chapter 2: The gas debt

The problem is, Oscar can't pay them back. And the gang members are running out of patience. They keep pushing him for the gas money, and their threats keep getting more serious.

Then one day, one of the gang members spots Oscar on the street and asks for the money. Oscar doesn't have it, so he runs. The gang member chases him through the streets. Oscar ducks down and hides behind a parked car. And right then, Bryant is sitting nearby having his morning coffee. He sees the scared kid crouching behind the car. And this is the first time Bryant really notices the boy who watches him every day.

But the trouble isn't over. Later that night, the gang members come to Oscar's house. They demand their gas money, and one of them puts a gun to Oscar's head. Oscar is terrified, and he hands the money over. That's the world this kid is growing up in.

Not long after, Bryant does something nobody expects. Instead of sending the kid away, Bryant starts teaching Oscar martial arts.

Bryant shows Oscar how to move. He teaches him how to defend himself and how to counter an attack. Most importantly, he teaches him how to stay calm in the middle of a fight. But Bryant makes one thing very clear from the start. What he is teaching is for self-defense only. It is not for becoming a street fighter.

Oscar loves the training. He grows more confident, and slowly starts to believe he can become a real fighter. Which is exactly what Bryant warned him about.

2:22 Chapter 3: Hector comes home

Then Hector gets out of prison. Oscar is thrilled to have his big brother back. But the excitement doesn't last long. Because as soon as Hector sees Bryant, he gets suspicious.

Hector studies Bryant's posture and the way he carries himself. To Hector, this man looks like a cop. Oscar tells him that Bryant is just his teacher and his friend. But Hector doesn't buy it.

And Hector's return brings something else back into Oscar's life. His old gang connections. The same gang that put a gun to Oscar's head is part of the family's life again.

Soon, Hector finds out that Oscar has been training with Bryant. And Hector doesn't see self-defense. He sees an opportunity. Oscar can fight. And Hector needs money. So Hector starts pulling Oscar toward the underground fighting world.

Before long, Oscar is standing inside an illegal underground fight. And this place is nothing like a normal gym. People are betting on the fighters. Money is changing hands everywhere. And the fighters are expected to entertain the crowd, no matter how badly someone gets hurt.

One fighter here has already made a name for himself as one of the toughest in the place. They call him The Collector. Oscar watches another fighter get badly beaten. Anyone with sense would walk out after seeing that.

3:28 Chapter 4: Oscar vs The Collector

But Oscar does the opposite. Out of nowhere, he decides he is going to fight. Even Hector is surprised. But Oscar steps in anyway.

At first, it looks like Oscar has made a terrible mistake. The Collector is bigger, stronger and far more experienced. One clean hit from him could end everything. But Oscar remembers everything Bryant taught him. He doesn't try to overpower The Collector. He moves quickly. He stays out of the way of unnecessary attacks. And he waits, calmly, for an opening.

And then the opening comes. Oscar takes it, and he defeats The Collector. The crowd goes crazy. A teenage kid has just beaten one of the most experienced fighters in the place.

Oscar also gets paid for the win. And for Hector, who badly needs money, that changes everything. To him, his little brother's fists suddenly look like a way out of all their problems.

But there is something nobody pays attention to. A girl in the crowd is recording the whole fight on her phone. Oscar's victory is now on video. And that one video is about to cause far bigger trouble than any gas debt.

4:26 Chapter 5: The video reaches Sonny

The girl who recorded the fight sends the video to a man named Piro. Elsewhere, Piro is out playing golf with some of his friends when the video comes in. He watches it, and something about it gets his attention. So Piro takes the video straight to a prison.

Because the man he needs to show it to is locked up. His name is Sonny Kilbane. Sonny is a powerful criminal who is serving a double life sentence. Piro shows him the fight. And as Sonny watches Oscar move, something clicks. He has seen this fighting style before. The way this kid fights is the way Bryant fights. That means whoever trained this boy must be Bryant.

Sonny wants to know where the fight happened. When he learns it was in Nogales, Mexico, he is sure. Bryant, the man who put him behind bars, has finally been found. So Sonny gives an order to the Guzman twins, two dangerous professional killers. Their job is to find Bryant.

Back in Nogales, Hector has no idea what is coming. He has a plan of his own. He wants Bryant to train Oscar properly, like a professional. So Hector takes Oscar to Bryant's house and asks him to train the boy. Bryant refuses. He doesn't want Oscar anywhere near professional or criminal fighting.

Hector gets angry. The argument keeps getting worse, until Hector pulls out a gun and threatens Bryant. But Bryant doesn't panic even a little. He pulls out his own gun and calmly tells Hector to move. And in that moment, Hector realizes this is not a man he can scare. He backs off to his car.

Oscar feels terrible and apologizes. But Bryant tells him not to come back. Even so, Oscar still believes Bryant truly wants to help him.

5:56 Chapter 6: Strangers at the gym

Later, Oscar and Hector go to an MMA gym, because Oscar wants to sign up. He wants to keep training and become a real, legitimate fighter. A girl named Marisol is there, helping out at her father's gym.

Right then, two big men walk up to them. They say they are interested in Oscar, because they have seen his fight. But Hector quickly realizes something is off. These men aren't here to recruit anybody. They are looking for Bryant.

Oscar and Hector act like they have no idea where Bryant is, and the men leave. But Oscar knows Bryant is now in danger, and it's because of his fight video.

Oscar begs Hector to let him warn Bryant. Hector says no at first. After all, the last time they went to Bryant's house, guns came out. But Oscar won't stop insisting, and finally Hector agrees. Oscar also says Marisol should come with them. So the three of them head to Bryant's house.

Marisol walks up to Bryant first. She tells him that people are looking for him, and that he should listen to Oscar. Oscar explains exactly what happened at the gym. And now Bryant's face turns serious. He asks them one question. Did they come here straight from the gym? Oscar says yes.

And that's when Bryant understands the mistake. Those men could have simply followed them here. Bryant tells everyone to get in the car and leave right now.

7:08 Chapter 7: The Guzman twins attack

But it's already too late. The Guzman twins attack, and they start shooting at Bryant's house. But Bryant's house is heavily reinforced, so the bullets don't get through.

Bryant watches the attackers on his security cameras. So he always knows exactly where they are. And his house has many ways in and out. So while the first twin is busy trying to shoot him, Bryant slips out another way and comes up behind him. He shoots the first twin from behind and kills him.

Now only one twin is left. The second twin is trying to open a door when Bryant appears right behind him. Bryant asks him who is behind the attack. The twin just warns him that his brother is coming. And Bryant tells him that he is one of a kind now, because his twin is already dead.

Bryant asks him again who sent them. Still no answer. So Bryant pours kerosene all over him, to show he isn't joking, and asks one last time. The twin curses at Bryant. And then, instead of giving up his boss, he sets himself on fire and dies. That's how far these people will go to protect the man behind them.

Now there is no point in hiding anymore. After the attack, Bryant finally tells Hector and the others the truth. And here it comes out that Bryant used to work with the LAPD and the DEA. Hector was right after all. He just didn't know how right.

Bryant had gone undercover against a huge criminal organization. This group dealt in drugs, illegal weapons and human trafficking. The man connected to all of it was Sonny Kilbane. Kilbane had influence over corrupt officials and even people inside law enforcement. Bryant's investigation helped bring the organization down and put Kilbane in prison.

8:38 Chapter 8: Why Bryant is as good as dead

But Bryant's success came with a terrible price. His enemies found out there was someone he loved. Her name was Heather. Heather was Bryant's wife. Since they couldn't easily get to Bryant himself, they went after the person closest to him. They found Heather and brutally attacked her.

After seeing what they did to Heather, Bryant understood something painful. As long as he stayed connected to her, she would always be a target. So he came up with an extreme plan to disappear.

Bryant told Heather to claim that he had assaulted her. It was a false domestic-violence story. And it gave Bryant a believable reason to vanish. Instead of people thinking he went into hiding because criminals were hunting him, they would think he ran away because of the accusation.

Heather stayed behind in their old city, while Bryant disappeared to Mexico. In a way, he made his own version of witness protection. He didn't trust the official system to keep him or the people he loved safe. So he chose to become invisible. To the outside world, Bryant was practically dead. And this is where the title of the movie finally makes sense. Bryant had made himself as good as dead.

Bryant also shows them something else. There is a secret tunnel underneath his property. The tunnel was first discovered through DEA work. And Bryant deliberately built his house in this exact spot, because the tunnel could be his escape route. He shows Oscar and the others how to use it to get away safely.

Then Bryant's old colleague, Bo Davis, shows up. Bo knows who Bryant really is. Bryant once saved his life, and when the DEA turned its back on Bryant, Bo was the one who tried to help him.

10:07 Chapter 9: Hector is taken

Then it comes out that Bryant once went undercover inside a prison as an underground cage fighter. He used that identity to get inside the same criminal organization. That operation is what eventually led him to Sonny Kilbane. Now it makes sense why Sonny recognized that fighting style so quickly.

But now, the people connected to Kilbane are coming after Bryant again. And this time, they are using the people around him to get to him. Their first target is Hector. Hector is kidnapped.

Bryant tracks down the vehicle where Hector is being held. He attacks the men guarding it, fights his way through, and pulls Hector out alive.

But while Bryant is busy saving Hector, Oscar and Marisol are still in danger. The two of them go to Hector's house. And there, they run into people connected to Bryant's old circle. One of them is Eric Green, Bryant's former colleague. Eric seems to be on their side. He tells Oscar that he is looking for Hector and wants to help.

Oscar trusts him. After all, he is one of Bryant's old partners. And that trust is exactly what the criminals were counting on. It turns out the whole thing is a

setup. Eric was never there to help. His fake kindness lets the criminals grab Oscar and Marisol, and both of them are driven away toward a trafficking operation.

11:16 Chapter 10: Oscar's secret code

In the car, on the way to the warehouse, Oscar manages to secretly call his brother. But the criminals catch him. They take his phone away from him.

Along the way, Oscar comes up with a trick. He tells the criminals he feels sick and needs to throw up. So they stop and let him out of the car. While he is outside, Oscar spots an address on a building. He quickly memorizes it.

Later, at the warehouse, the criminals want Oscar to bring his brother to them. So they make him text Hector and tell him to come. Oscar realizes this is his one chance to leave Bryant a clue. So along with the message, he sends the address he memorized on the road.

The criminals don't understand why he sent it. They demand to know what it means. Oscar tells them the address is a code that only his brother understands. They believe him. And they have no idea that Oscar has just told Bryant where to look. Not bad for a kid who couldn't even make it to school on time.

Between Oscar's call and that address, Bryant is able to figure out where Oscar is. And Bryant realizes the truth. Oscar and Marisol have been taken to a human-trafficking operation. The same kind of operation Bryant once worked to bring down.

Bryant immediately starts planning a rescue. He tells Hector that he knows where Oscar is. Hector wants in, and he joins him. Together, they study the location and work out a plan to get inside. They don't just drive up and start shooting. They set up an ambush. Once the plan is ready, they drive toward the trafficking warehouse.

12:41 Chapter 11: Assault on the warehouse

Inside the warehouse, Oscar and Marisol are being used as bait. The criminals expect Bryant to come for them. And they are right. But Bryant is ready.

When Bryant and Hector reach the warehouse, the gunfight begins. Bullets fly everywhere. The criminals shoot from windows, from doorways and from behind cover. Bryant and Hector fire back as they keep moving forward.

At one point, Bryant is pinned down by heavy gunfire. Then Bryant notices something. One of the enemies is hiding behind cover, but his boots are sticking out underneath it. Instead of exposing himself, Bryant shoots straight at the man's feet. That forces him out of hiding.

Bryant moves through the warehouse slowly and carefully, taking the attackers down one by one, with Hector fighting right beside him.

Finally, Bryant reaches the men holding Oscar and Marisol. But one of the traffickers gets a clear shot at Bryant. Bryant doesn't see him. Hector does. Hector raises his gun and shoots the man before he can kill Bryant. The same guy who once pulled a gun on Bryant has now saved his life.

13:36 Chapter 12: Eric Green

And now Oscar comes face to face with Eric Green, the man who set him up. Then it comes out that Eric was once Bryant's teammate and protégé. Eric betrayed Bryant and helped the criminals use Oscar to find him. Eric believed that because he trained under Bryant, he knew exactly how Bryant thinks.

But Eric made one big mistake. He underestimated Oscar. Because Oscar was trained by Bryant too. The two of them fight, and Oscar uses everything Bryant taught him. And this time, the student wins. Oscar lands a hard punch, and Eric falls to the ground.

But Eric isn't finished. He grabs a gun and points it at Oscar. He is about to shoot. Right then, Marisol grabs a weapon and shoots Eric in the leg first. Eric collapses, screaming as he bleeds.

Bryant hears the screams and runs into the room. And there, on the floor, is his former teammate. The man who sold him out. Eric expects Bryant to finish him. But Bryant tells him he has already called the DEA and the FBI, and they are on their way. Then he tells Oscar and Marisol to leave Eric right there. If he bleeds out, he dies. But he will probably be fine, because the ambulances are already coming. Either way, Eric will face the consequences of his betrayal.

The trafficking operation is finally destroyed. Oscar survives. Marisol survives. Hector survives too. And Bryant has finally faced the criminal organization that forced him to disappear all those years ago.

And there is one more person who comes back into Bryant's life. Heather. The wife he had to leave behind in their old city comes to Mexico to see him. After

years of living apart to keep her safe, Bryant finally gets to see her again.

At the start, Oscar was a troubled kid who kept showing up late to school because he was watching Bryant train. By the end, he can protect himself and the people he cares about. And Bryant, after years of living like he was already dead, finally stops running from his past.

And with this, the story ends right here. Do tell us in the comments how you liked this explanation. And don't forget to like the video and subscribe to the channel.